

Research Status Note

Public CAD Is Not Operational Ground Truth — R16.1

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Four findings to retain

The released public-field convention changes abruptly on 28 July 2021. Hurricane Ida produces a second, temporary change inside that later convention. Its largest half-day field-state change is 53.2 percentage points, larger than all 151 post-change ordinary-week comparisons. The public record does not reveal physical response or the institutional mechanism that generated the released fields.

Evidence behind the sequence.

- In 419,840 non-officer-initiated records created through 27 July 2021, none has a valid arrival field without a dispatch field. The configuration first appears on 28 July, when officer-stream dispatch coverage also falls from 100 percent to 40 percent and then to 1 percent on 29 July.
- During Ida, the public missing-dispatch share reaches 43.4 percent on 31 August and 49.3 percent on 1 September. The 29 August arrival-field dip and a smaller 10 September excursion show that missingness changes form across days.
- The full-count post-change comparison is primary. A standardized comparison also places Ida first but covers only 86.1 percent of event and 77.0 percent of baseline records and fails the 0.90 reference eligibility rule.
- The comparable non-officer dispatch-field series is 65.4 percent in 2024, 66.0 percent in 2025, and 66.8 percent in the 2026 snapshot. Pooling officer-initiated records produces a different denominator and a lower all-row rate.
- Public documents define field labels and exclude two proposed technology explanations. They do not supply a versioned 2021 changelog or an internal-to-public lineage bridge.

Version boundary. Paper R16.1 is a minor editorial successor to R16.0. Its scientific results remain the validated R15.1 evidence package; no numerical result was changed or promoted.

Deliverables. A standalone main paper, empirical supplement, this one-page note, reproduction manual, and separate legacy mathematical/formal-verification archive. The combined reviewer PDF contains only the main paper and empirical supplement.